

Philipp Hilbert. *Founding product operator, zero to one and beyond.*

Positioning, hands-on PM with ten years of B2B SaaS and enterprise software delivery who builds the systems that let product teams move faster without losing rigor.

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§ WHY FARSEER

Farseer is attacking a problem that has resisted every prior attempt: enterprise software that finance teams actually want to use. The job description explicitly names CFOs and FP&A managers as the primary users, which is the same stakeholder profile I have navigated in regulated, high-stakes B2B environments across InsurTech, public-sector analytics, and defence-adjacent data platforms. The signal that resonates most is the framing around turning finance teams into proactive strategists rather than spreadsheet custodians – that is exactly the kind of workflow-level insight that drives good product decisions, not feature lists. The emphasis on doing product management rather than presenting it, owning the roadmap, saying no to good ideas, and closing the loop between customer evidence and engineering matches how I have operated at every stage of my career. *That is exactly the environment where a low-ego, high-agency operator compounds.*

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not worked inside a finance or FP&A software company as a domain expert. My exposure to financial workflows comes from operating as a CFO and financial planning lead at Smart Soil Technologies and from building tooling around financial data, not from sitting inside a dedicated FP&A product team. The transferable mechanic is strong: I translate dense, workflow-heavy domain knowledge into structured requirements that engineers can ship, which is precisely the skill that makes a finance PM effective once the domain is learned.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude**, spec drafting, edge-case generation, requirements review
- **GPT**, structured synthesis, customer-interview analysis, PRD iteration
- **GitHub Copilot**, in-editor implementation support and code review
- **Cursor / VSCode**, day-to-day development and prototyping environment
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping and stakeholder demos
- **Framer**, design-heavy wireframes and interactive mockups
- **Gamma.app**, structured product presentations and stakeholder briefs
- **n8n**, multi-agent workflow automation and agentic loop design

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), JavaScript, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, Argo Workflows, OpenShift, Docker, Jenkins, GitOps pipelines, dbt, Dagster, DuckDB, MicroStrategy, Redpanda, Django, AngularJS, Ionic, Bitbucket, Git, low-code insurance platforms, CGM API integration, Shopware.

§ SIDE PROJECT

BACKTESTING AND TRADING AUTOMATION [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Self-built infrastructure for systematic crypto strategy research and execution.

- Implements a backtesting engine for crypto market strategies, including perpetual futures and spot mechanics.
- Structured as a file-queue-based agent loop with modular components for data ingestion, signal generation, and order simulation.
- Draws on liquidation heatmap data from Coinglass and Hyblock Capital to model market microstructure inputs.
- Demonstrates the same end-to-end ownership model Farseer needs: problem definition, architecture decision, implementation, and iteration without a committee.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT FARSEER

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Join sales calls and implementation sessions immediately, map the current customer discovery and prioritization workflow exactly as it exists, and identify where decisions slow down or lose signal before reaching engineering.

WEEK 2

Sharpen the loop.

Run two to three structured discovery sessions with existing customers – specifically CFOs or FP&A leads – and produce a written synthesis that either confirms the current roadmap assumptions or surfaces a gap worth acting on.

WEEK 3+

Ship and close.

Pick the highest-leverage near-term item from the validated roadmap, write the spec, align engineering, and drive it to production – measuring adoption against the specific business outcome it was built to move.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Farseer team,

I am applying for the Product Manager role because the problem you are solving is one I find genuinely interesting: rebuilding the operational layer of enterprise software from first principles, starting with finance. That is a harder problem than it looks, and the job description suggests you already know why – it is not a technology gap, it is a workflow and trust gap. Finance teams have been burned by software that promised clarity and delivered complexity. Closing that gap requires a PM who can sit in the room with CFOs, understand what they are actually doing (not what the persona doc says they do), and translate that into something engineering can ship without losing the nuance.

That is the work I have done across most of my career, in different domains but with the same mechanics. At Emil Group, I inherited a B2B InsurTech platform where client trust had broken down, sprint discipline had collapsed, and a 17-person team was producing noise instead of

output. I split the team, reintroduced velocity tracking and structured refinement, ran weekly product workshops with clients directly, and reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure. The product shipped. At Rohde and Schwarz, I delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end on a government defence programme where requirements were incomplete by design and the cost of a wrong decision was measured in months, not sprints. I unblocked infrastructure problems independently that engineers had been deferring for over a year. At the Federal Employment Agency, I served as both PM and Deputy IT Security Officer on a public analytics platform, managing compliance, data lineage, and a migration to Kubernetes while continuing to ship features.

On the finance domain gap: I have not been a full-time PM inside an FP&A software company. I have operated as CFO and financial planning lead at Smart Soil Technologies, which gave me direct exposure to how finance workflows actually run under pressure – budget cycles, forecasting under uncertainty, investor reporting, and the gap between what a spreadsheet shows and what a decision-maker needs. I understand the problem from the user side. The PM skill I bring – structured discovery, workflow decomposition, requirements that engineers can act on – transfers directly once the domain vocabulary is mapped.

What I am specifically drawn to in the Farseer role is the framing around doing product management rather than presenting it. I have spent my career in environments where the processes did not exist yet and someone had to build them while also shipping. I do not need consensus to make a call, and I am comfortable defending a no on a feature when the evidence points that way. I am also technically fluent enough to challenge architectural assumptions in the room with engineers, not just relay them – at Rohde and Schwarz I was the sole contributor on a feature the project lead had been requesting from the engineering team for over a year. I delivered it in one week.

I would welcome a conversation about where Farseer is in its product development cycle and what the most important unsolved prioritization problem looks like right now.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Hands-on Product Manager and Product Owner with nearly ten years of experience translating complex operational workflows into scalable B2B software. Background spans enterprise SaaS platforms, regulated public-sector analytics, AI data systems, and founder-level company building. Comfortable operating in ambiguity and high-pressure delivery environments where

requirements are incomplete and teams need clarity to move. Fluent in AI-native workflows including LLM-assisted development, rapid prototyping, and autonomous feature delivery. Brings founding-stage pragmatism, low ego, and direct accountability for outcomes.

§ CORE STRENGTHS

- Translating dense operational workflows into dev-ready requirements
 - Customer discovery and evidence-based roadmap prioritization
 - Cross-functional alignment across engineering, sales, CS, and leadership
 - Shipping features that move business metrics, not feature counts
 - Backlog discipline, sprint structure, and delivery velocity management
 - Technical fluency sufficient to challenge engineering assumptions directly
 - AI-native execution: spec generation, prototyping, and iteration tooling
 - Workshop facilitation and stakeholder trust rebuilding under pressure
 - Founder-level agency: acts, then explains, does not wait for consensus
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§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ 2024, 2025

Product Manager, AI Data Transformation

- Delivered autonomous feature sets end-to-end: user stories, acceptance criteria, implementation support, testing, GitOps rollout – sole contributor on a feature deferred by the engineering team for over a year, delivered in one week
- Led cross-functional team of architect, data scientists, backend and frontend engineers, and QA against incomplete government-programme requirements
- Reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps with ArgoCD
- Improved data quality via filtering, tagging, reproducible transformation pipelines, and full data provenance audit trails
- Enabled ML training and evaluation on curated datasets with transparent SafeAI and ExplainableAI evaluation concepts

FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY (BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT) 2023, 2024

Product Manager, Public Data Analytics

- Shipped labour shortage analytics, flexible regional comparison tooling, and modernised admin interfaces on the Arbeitsmarktmonitor platform
- Introduced Dagster for automated ETL and indicator generation, standardised CI/CD with full test integration at build time
- Migrated legacy systems to Kubernetes and managed major version upgrades without service interruption
- Served as Deputy IT Security Officer with responsibility for compliance, governance, and data lineage across a politically sensitive public platform

EMIL GROUP 2022

Product Manager, InsurTech SaaS Platform

- Designed and delivered a Claims Center module from concept to production rollout on a B2B InsurTech platform serving primary insurers, reinsurers, MGAs, and brokers
- Re-established sprint discipline after delivery breakdown: split a bloated 17-person team into focused Scrum units, introduced ownership and deputy concepts, reintroduced velocity tracking
- Regained client trust in a prototype-stage environment through structured weekly product workshops and transparent communication
- Reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure across the engagement

CLINET PLATFORMS 2021, 2022

Product Owner, Mobile Healthcare App

- Delivered core patient-facing flows (digital anamnesis, meal and therapy plans, transport, chat, document storage) on iOS and Android under tight deadlines
- Integrated CGM interface into hospital information system workflows, managing legacy API constraints transparently with stakeholders
- Maintained delivery focus by structuring the backlog around highest-leverage features and communicating trade-offs clearly to clinical and technical stakeholders

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

QCRYPT AG 2016, 2018

Product Owner & Deputy IT Security Officer

- Owned product architecture for a quantum-secure encryption product based on one-time-pad keys and true random number generator hardware
- Defined backup, restore/checkpoint, and data-encryption subsystems; drove the USP of sub-two-minute setup requiring no technical knowledge
- Served as deputy IT security officer, responsible for attack vector mitigation and compliance posture

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS 2013, 2018

Founder & CFO

- Built a group-based P2P payment product on a P2P backbone, including PSP integration, full UX/UI design, and mobile app prototype
- Later acquired and operated by Sparkasse

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES 2016, 2021

Co-Founder, CDO, CFO & Head of HR

- Led financial planning, investor relations, ERP introduction, and digital tooling establishment for a nanotechnology vertical-farming startup
- Operated as CFO across full budget cycle, forecasting under uncertainty, and investment reporting – direct exposure to the financial planning workflows Farseer targets

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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